

Mega Menu Architecture Grooming

Meeting Notes

Date	July 7, 2026	Project	Mega Menu Merchandising
Meeting Type	Architecture / Grooming Session	Status	Open Questions — Pre-Grooming
Participants	PM (Smith), Nav Architecture (Sam), Ari, NavArk Dev, Daniel (Audio Merch), Matt (BI), Birdie (UX)	Next Step	PM to deliver requirements doc + book follow-up session

Executive Summary

This working session focused on architecture and UX rules for the Mega Menu Merchandising initiative. Key topics: how **category labels** (bucket headers in the DES), **Featured Slots** (up to 5 per top-level category), and **custom URLs** interact in both the admin tool and the customer-facing mega menu. The team worked through taxonomy constraints, display logic edge cases, duplication rules, label-as-parent functionality, and UX labeling of the featured section. The session concluded that formal **DS/DES requirements** must be authored and reviewed before grooming can proceed.

1 | Key Topics Discussed

1A — Category Labels as Pseudo-Parents ('Step-Parent' Model)

The most substantive discussion centered on whether DES category labels (e.g., Accessories, Cameras & Lenses) can act as collapsible parent nodes in the mega menu without altering the underlying taxonomy hierarchy.

- Labels are currently visual-only text anchors (H2 elements with auto-generated HTML IDs) — they have no true category ID or parent-child relationship in the taxonomy.
- The team coined a 'step-parent' or 'pseudo-parent' concept: a label that visually groups children in the mega menu fly-out without creating a real taxonomy parent.
- Consensus: a **checkbox per label in the DES** will control whether that label becomes a collapsible node in the mega menu. Default = unchecked.
- When checked, the label's children are **hidden from the flat list** and appear as a fly-out on mouse-over.
- The checkbox is **mega-menu-display-only** — it does not alter category landing pages, breadcrumbs, or the DES hierarchy.
- Labels cannot be converted to clickable links (mouse-over only). Clicking a label may anchor-link to a section of the parent category page (e.g., /989#accessories), but this requires front-end confirmation.

1B — Featured Slots: Types, Rules, and Edge Cases

Featured slots occupy the top 5 positions per top-level category. Three slot types confirmed:

- **Category ID** — most common; merchandiser types the CI directly.
- **Label** — selected from a surfaced list/dropdown of available labels for that category.
- **Custom URL** — free-form URL for promotions, events, or special landing pages.

Key edge case rules:

- **Label in Featured = auto-collapsed:** Placing a label in a featured slot implicitly activates the pseudo-parent behavior; no separate checkbox needed for featured use.
- **No duplication at L2:** A level-2 category featured in the top 5 should NOT also appear in its natural position in the same column. L3/L4 items may appear in both locations.
- **Slot inheritance prohibited:** Deleting a featured label or category does NOT automatically promote the next item. Every featured position must be intentionally assigned.
- **Block deletion of in-use labels:** A label assigned to a featured slot cannot be deleted from the DES until it is first removed from featured.
- **Max 5, not required 5:** A category can have fewer than 5 featured items; vacated slots do not auto-fill.

1C — Custom URLs and Redirect Workaround

- Merchandisers may need to feature non-category destinations (events, Father's Day, FIFA-style curated pages).
- Proposed workaround: create a DES category with a redirect URL pointing to the desired landing page, preserving CI-only architecture.
- CI + query parameters (e.g., /22144?brand=X) and CI + hash anchors are valid custom URL patterns for promotions.
- Fully custom (non-CI) landing pages remain an open architecture question for Ari and Sam.

1D — 'Used' Category Mapping in the Mega Menu

- An existing used-to-new mapping in the DES was built for refinement/counter scripts, not front-end display.
- Requested: when hovering a top-level category, show a contextual 'Used [Category]' entry where the mapping exists.
- The mapping is incomplete at mid/high taxonomy levels. Where no used inventory exists (e.g., Used Mobile), the link should not appear.
- Feasibility and coverage confirmation required from Ari.

1E — UX Labeling of the Featured Section ('Featured' vs. 'Popular')

- Current design uses green bars as the only visual indicator for featured — no explicit text label.
- Birdie (UX) noted the green bars were not intuitively read as 'featured'; she had mistaken the Specials column for the featured section.
- Discussed renaming 'Featured' to **'Popular'** to reduce perception of sponsorship. Counter: featured items may include new categories with no click history, making 'Popular' semantically inaccurate.
- Team aligned: the featured section needs a **visible text label** (e.g., the word 'Featured'). Green bars alone are insufficient.
- Birdie recommended a usability test to validate user perception before launch.

- Noted: UX has trended toward subtlety recently; the team acknowledged this may have overcorrected for this feature.

1F — Grooming Readiness and Requirements Gap

- Grooming (sprint planning and dev estimation) **cannot proceed** until formal DS/DES requirements are written.
- PM (Smith) to author requirements covering: label checkbox behavior, featured slot rules, deletion guard logic, duplication rules, and used-category mapping.
- Requirements will be shared with Sam Herman (architecture) for review, then reflected in the Figma file.
- Cable Finder data reliability is a separate open question for a future Ari + PM session.
- New Arrivals / Used labeling wording (e.g., 'Pro Video New Arrivals') requires copy finalization.

2 | Open Questions

#	Question	Owner	Status
OQ-1	Can label IDs be reliably used as HTML anchor targets to enable click-through from the mega menu to a category page section?	Ari / Sam	Open
OQ-2	Is the used-to-new mapping feasible at mid/high taxonomy levels? What is the realistic coverage?	Ari	Open
OQ-3	Can the DES support a row/group ID on labels to enable pseudo-parent fly-out without taxonomy restructuring?	Sam / Nav Arch	Open
OQ-4	Is Cable Finder data in the DES reliable enough to drive a dynamic mega menu entry?	Ari / PM	Open (prior chat logged)
OQ-5	Should featured L3/L4 categories appear twice (featured + natural position) or once? Partially resolved for L2; open for lower levels.	NavArk / UX	Partially resolved
OQ-6	What is the final wording for the featured section label? ('Featured', 'Popular', etc.) Should a usability test validate this?	UX / PM	Open
OQ-7	Should drag-and-drop from child categories to feature slots be re-added to the merch admin tool scope?	PM / Dev	Open — previously de-scoped
OQ-8	Finalize wording for new arrivals and used mega menu entries (e.g., 'Pro Video New Arrivals' vs. 'New Releases in Pro Video').	PM / Copy	Open

3 | Decisions Made

Decision	Detail
Label collapsing is display-only	Activating a label checkbox changes mega menu display only; no taxonomy changes are made. Category landing pages and breadcrumbs unaffected.

Decision	Detail
No hierarchy redesign for mega menu	The mega menu will show the existing hierarchy differently — it will NOT restructure the taxonomy to accommodate mega menu UX needs.
Grooming blocked pending requirements	Formal DS/DES requirements must be authored and shared with Sam Herman before any grooming session can proceed.
Featured deletion guard	Labels or categories in active featured slots cannot be deleted from the DES until first removed from featured configuration.
Slot inheritance prohibited	Removing a featured item never auto-promotes the next available item. All featured slot assignments must be intentional.
No L2 duplication	A level-2 category assigned to featured should not also appear in its natural column position. L3/L4 items may appear in both locations.
Featured label text required	The featured section must display explicit text (e.g., 'Featured'). Green bars alone are insufficient for user orientation.
Merchandising cadence	Featured changes expected monthly to bi-monthly (event-driven). Label-level collapses expected even less frequently.

4 | Action Items

Owner	Action	Target Date	Priority
PM (Smith)	Author formal DS/DES requirements doc: label checkbox behavior, featured slot types, deletion guard, duplication rules, used-category mapping scope.	Before next grooming session	P0
PM (Smith)	Update Figma file with all decisions from Friday's and today's sessions.	Before next meeting	P0
PM (Smith)	Book follow-up architecture/grooming session (same crew). Agenda: review requirements doc and resolve open questions.	This week	P0
PM (Smith)	Distribute these meeting notes to architecture team and Sam Herman.	Today	P1
Ari	Investigate used-to-new mapping coverage: confirm availability at mid/high taxonomy levels; identify feasible mega menu entry points.	Before next session	P1
Sam / Nav Arch	Confirm whether DES label group/row IDs can serve as pseudo-parent signal for mega menu fly-out without taxonomy restructuring.	Before grooming	P1

Owner	Action	Target Date	Priority
Sam / Nav Arch	Review and respond to PM's requirements doc. Flag architecture constraints or blockers.	After PM delivers doc	P1
UX (Birdie)	Scope a usability test to validate user perception of the featured section (with/without text label, 'Featured' vs. 'Popular').	TBD	P2
PM / Copy (Alice)	Finalize wording for: featured section header label, new arrivals mega menu entry, and used category entry per top-level category.	Before A/B test launch	P2
Ari / PM	Schedule separate session to evaluate Cable Finder data reliability in DES for a dynamic mega menu entry.	TBD	P2

5 | Context and Sequencing Notes

- **This session is pre-grooming.** No story points or sprint assignments were made. The output is a requirements doc + a follow-up meeting.
- **Mega Menu initiative timeline:** Label checkbox feature, featured slot management, and used-category mapping are Phase 1 scope. Cable Finder and drag-and-drop slot management are under consideration for a later phase.
- **A/B test plan remains intact.** Control vs. treatment test structure (95% CI standard, four-tier KPI framework) is unchanged. This session resolves UX and architecture pre-conditions before development begins.
- **H2 Descriptive Copy** and **Highlighted Refinements** remain sequenced AFTER the mega menu merchandising tool goes live to preserve clean attribution.
- **Merch Admin Tool** (merch-tool.html on GitHub Pages) will need updates to the slot-type selector once label-dropdown and pseudo-parent checkbox requirements are finalized.